Style HERITAGE

Action sports gave birth to rad wardrobes.

Skateboarding and surfing transformed attitudes, styles and everything else you can think of when they burst onto the cultural map in the '70s and '80s, paving the way for snowboarding's deep impact in the '90s. The bro'd-out beginnings of these sports spawned some of today's sickest brands, and we're paying homage to the ones that take us back...way back.

1973

BILLABONG

Billabong might mean "a stagnant tide pool" in Aussie-English, but this 33-year-old company runs like a well-oiled machine. The brand's biggest project has been the Billabong Odyssey—the quest to surf a 100-foot wave (that's no typo).

1975

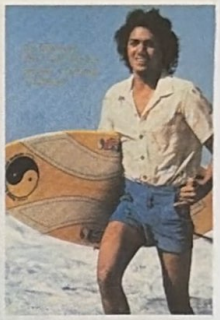
OAKLEY

The "O" introduces slip-proof moto-cross grips, and soon after that it evolves into the premier eyewear company in the universe, raking in a staggering $650 million in 2005 alone.

1977

BURTON SNOW-BOARDS

A young Jake Burton, having failed to make his college ski team, takes a ride on a "Snurfer" and a little thing called snowboarding is quietly born.



1977

OP

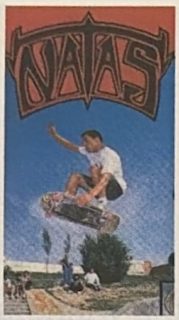
One of the marketing directors at Op underwrites the fledgling Association of Professional Surfers, and an invasion of silky Hawaiian prints and corduroy shorts commences.

Billabong surfers, circa whenever retina-searing neon was in.

1980

VANS

Skater Steve Caballero invents the "Caballerial" and soon becomes a Vans athlete. Fourteen years earlier, Paul Van Doren and his partners had begun selling their kicks for just $2.49.



1987

ETNIES

Just one year after Etnies becomes the first brand to be owned by a professional skater, the Natas—named after Lithuanian punk Natas Kaupas—becomes the first pro-model skate shoe.

1988

QUIKSILVER

Australian surf sensation Tom Carroll signs with Quik. Florida phenom Kelly Slater augments the roster two years later and goes on to win the ASP World Championship seven times.

1991

VOLCOM

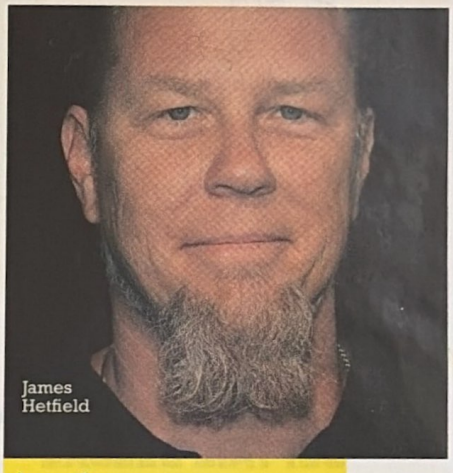
After riding in Tahoe, founders Tucker Hall and Richard Woolcott borrow $5,000 and start selling shirts. They make $2,600—a far cry from the $113 million Volcom pulls down each year.

2002

DC SHOES

Less than 10 years after Ken Block and Damon Way founded DC Shoes, Way's brother Danny builds the fabled Megaramp and blows almost every big-air record out of the water.

GROOMING



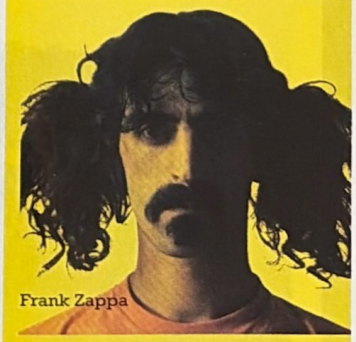
James Hetfield

FACE TIME

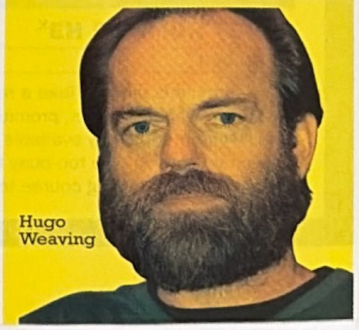
FASHION YOU CAN GROW!

Sometimes the coolest styles don't cost an arm and a leg—they just appear on your cheeks and upper lip. So what are you waiting for? Get to grooming like these trailblazers!

Eugene Hutz



Frank Zappa



Hugo Weaving